

KORE.AI COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Competitive Signal Report

Topic: Enterprise agentic AI & contact-center AI (CCAI) · Window: last 72h · Saturday, 08 August 2026 · 08:57 IST
Prepared by Kore.ai Competitive Intelligence

Bottom line: Competitors like Five9 and NICE are highlighting AI revenue growth and new agent capabilities, but their underlying business models and integration strategies present clear opportunities for Kore.ai's proven, unified platform and deterministic ABL.

Five9's AI Revenue Surge Masks Seat-Model Vulnerability

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-08-07) Five9 reported Q2 guidance beat with AI revenue jumping 78%, and secured a new \$100 million contract driven by voice AI agents, as detailed by CMSWire. [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)
This highlights the market's demand for AI in CX, but Five9's continued reliance on a seat-based model, even with AI add-ons, is a vulnerability. Kore.ai's outcome-based pricing and ABL's deterministic execution offer superior TCO and reliability, especially as AI drives higher containment.

NICE Bolsters AI Credibility with Cognigy Integration and Enterprise Deals

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-08-06) NICE reported strong Q2 revenue growth and raised its EPS outlook, driven by cloud and AI, while also securing significant CX AI deals. The Globe and Mail also noted that NICE landed its biggest deal ever, though Wall Street seeks more proof of enterprise adoption. CMSWire and CX Today covered these developments. [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)
NICE's acquisition of Cognigy is a strategic move to bolster its AI narrative. However, the integration of two AI lineages (Cognigy and Enlighten) presents potential roadmap ambiguity and governance challenges that Kore.ai's single-stack, ABL-driven platform inherently avoids, offering clearer path to production-ready, auditable AI.

Sierra Lands CarMax, Signaling Continued Enterprise Land Grab in Conversational AI

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-08-06) Sierra has partnered with CarMax to enhance its inbound call experience using AI voice agents, as reported by Quiver Quantitative and CMSWire. [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)
This win underscores the intense competition for enterprise logos in conversational AI. Kore.ai's established analyst leadership in Conversational AI Platforms, coupled with its proven omnichannel capabilities and deterministic ABL, provides a more robust and validated solution for enterprises seeking true end-to-end CX automation beyond voice-first or nascent agent platforms.

AT A GLANCE

Signal priority table

Competitor	Move (dated)	Threat	Kore.ai counter
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Five9	(2026-08-07) Q2 AI revenue jumps 78%, lands \$100M contract — CMSWire	High	Deterministic ABL vs. seat-model overages
NICE (Cognigy)	(2026-08-06) Beats Q2 guidance, raises EPS outlook on AI growth, lands largest deal — The Globe and Mail	High	Unified stack vs. dual AI lineage integration
Sierra	(2026-08-06) Partners with CarMax for AI voice agents — Quiver Quantitative	Med	Proven omnichannel + analyst leadership vs. voice-first focus
Agentforce (Salesforce)	(2026-08-07) Wyndham offers self-service with Agentforce — Salesforce	Med	Platform-agnostic model routing vs. Salesforce ecosystem lock-in
Parloa	(2026-08-07) Study finds older consumers trust AI customer service most — MarTech Cube	Low	Enterprise-grade validation vs. limited analyst recognition

ON THE RADAR

Watch for

- Continued integration progress and customer proof points for NICE Cognigy.
- Sierra's ability to scale beyond voice and demonstrate broader CX platform capabilities.
- Salesforce's continued push for Agentforce adoption in contact center use cases.

SO WHAT — DO THIS NOW

Recommended actions

- Emphasize Kore.ai's ABL for deterministic, auditable AI and predictable TCO in sales conversations, contrasting with the potential overages and integration complexities of competitors like Five9 and NICE.
- Highlight Kore.ai's leadership in independent analyst evaluations for Conversational AI Platforms (Gartner, Forrester) as a key differentiator against newer entrants like Sierra.
- Reinforce Kore.ai's true omnichannel capabilities and voice-native architecture to counter voice-first or voice-centric solutions.
- Arm Sales with clear talking points on the risks of dual AI lineages and platform lock-in associated with acquisitions like NICE Cognigy.

EVIDENCE TRAIL

Sources

- (2026-08-07) Five9 Beats Q2 Guidance as AI Revenue Jumps 78% - CMSWire

- (2026-08-07) Five9 Stock Jumps After Q2 Growth, Higher Outlook, and Large New Customer Win - Quiver Quantitative
- (2026-08-07) Five9 Lands Approximately \$100 Million Contract As Voice AI Agents Drive Contact Center Push - Pulse 2.0
- (2026-08-06) NICE Beats Q2 Revenue Guidance and Raises 2026 EPS Outlook on Strong Cloud and AI Growth - The Globe and Mail
- (2026-08-06) NiCE Wins Big CX AI Deals, But Enterprise Adoption Takes Time - CX Today
- (2026-08-06) NiCE Landed Its Biggest Deal Ever. Wall Street Wants More Proof. - CMSWire
- (2026-08-06) CarMax Partners with Sierra to Improve Inbound Call Experience with AI Voice Agents - Quiver Quantitative
- (2026-08-06) Sierra Lands CarMax as Conversational AI's Enterprise Land Grab Widens - CMSWire
- (2026-08-07) Wyndham offers convenient self-service for franchisees with Agentforce - Salesforce
- (2026-08-07) Parloa Study Finds Older Consumers Trust AI Customer Service Most - MarTech Cube